Spanda-Karikas teach that the god *Shiva* manifests itself as the cosmos. *Shiva* names a single, all-inclusive trans-individual self-aware consciousness spontaneously flashing forth as all subjects, acts and objects of awareness through its dynamic power of vibration (*spanda*). A limiting condition called *anava* ***mala*** reduces universal consciousness to limited subjects of experience embodied in particular circumstances (*mayiya-**mala***) where they acquire a burden of good and bad ***karma*** which propels them into further spheres of experience.

Liberation (***moksha***) on the part of the fully enlightened person is understood as the realisation of one's identity as the creative principle that is the essence of all experiences.

Further reading: Dyczkowski 1987; Singh 1980

Sphota ('undivided meaning'): the grammarian and philosopher ***Bhartrihari*** saw that the primary linguistic fact is the sentence with an undivided meaning (*sphota*) and that individual words are abstractions from sentences. Meaning is not to be identified with evanescent sounds. Just as we do not understand a word after hearing its final element and combining it with remembered sounds of the preceding elements (when I hear 'mystery', I don't first think of mist), so we do not gradually understand a series of individual words and then combine them to understand the sentence. Rather, the latter is grasped immediately and instantaneously as a whole (*pratibha*: 'flash of insight') and not as the result of a mental synthesis. The meaning-bearer is not identical with the collection of sounds but is revealed by it. The word is as an entire meaningful symbol (*sphota*). It is a mental entity manifested by physical sounds. The unchanging word that conveys meaning is called *sphota*. It is distinct from the phonemes and is manifested by them. In normal language, it is the sentence, or